Field manual for nodal officers and supervisors

Leading the survey in your district: teams, schedule, quality and data

Independent NDD Coverage Evaluation Survey, Madhya Pradesh, November 2026

For the Community Medicine faculty and senior residents leading the survey in Khandwa, Chhindwara, Ratlam and Shahdol

Drafted with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic); reviewed by the AIIMS Bhopal survey team.

Your role

Teams	Form pairs, assign team numbers, make sure every member is trained and has a configured phone
Schedule	Allocate the 30 clusters to pairs, one cluster per pair per day, in two phases
Quality	Observe each pair (F9), back-check households (F8), review and sign off every F4
Data	Read the daily report from AIIMS; act on flags the same day
Liaison	Work with the DIO for letters, vehicles and introductions; keep implementers out of interviews
Escalation	Decide nothing that changes the sample; call the AIIMS coordinator

District teams from the nominations

District	Nodal officer(s)	Members → pairs → clusters per pair
Khandwa	Dr Anant T. Pawar	10 (faculty, SRs, PGs) → 5 pairs → 6 each
Chhindwara	Dr Vikas Dwivedi; Dr Prachi Jasuja (SR)	7 (2 JRs, 5 interns) → 3 pairs + 1 → 10 each
Ratlam	Dr Dhruvendra Pandey; Dr S.K. Likhar (Head)	9 (faculty, SR, PGs) → 4 pairs + 1 → 7–8 each
Shahdol	Dr Vikrant Kabirpanthi; Dr Akash Ranjan Singh	7 (1 demonstrator, 6 interns) → 3 pairs + 1 → 10 each

Chhindwara and Shahdol: 10 cluster-days per pair, mostly interns. Add a pair (SR or JR) or plan a longer field window.

Forming pairs and numbering teams

Pairing

- Pair an experienced member (faculty, SR, PG, JR) with an intern
- At least one woman in a pair where possible: many respondents are mothers
- Language: Gondi (Tamia, Shahdol), Bhili (Sailana), Nimadi (Khandwa). Pair a speaker, or use a neutral interpreter, never the ASHA or AWW
- Keep pairs fixed for the whole survey

App users and team numbers

- ratlam01–10 = teams 1–10
- chhindwara01–10 = teams 11–20
- shahdol01–10 = teams 21–30
- khandwa01–10 = teams 31–40
- Your own code: district_nodal (F8, F9)
- Both phones of a pair scan the same code; unused codes are spares

Scheduling the 30 clusters

1. Phase 1: the clusters released first (about half, by block). Phase 2 follows on the date announced
2. Give each pair clusters in one block to cut travel; one cluster per pair per day
3. Keep one buffer day per pair per phase for revisits and bad weather
4. Tell the BMO and DIO the next day’s clusters only the day before; never tell households
5. Send the schedule (pair, cluster, date) to the AIIMS data manager

Never swap a cluster for an easier one. Only the AIIMS coordinator can replace a cluster, and only if it truly cannot be reached.

Before the first field day

Training	Every member attended, did the field practice and passed the post-test
Phones	Both phones of each pair scanned the team QR; three forms visible; test form sent
Letters	Authorization letters from NHM and the medical college, one set per pair
Lists A/B	Cards printed from the AIIMS PDF and laminated, two per pair
Tablets	Sample albendazole 400 mg tablets from the DIO, a few per pair
Vehicles	Mobility support confirmed with the DIO for every field day

Codes, practice data and launch

Codes	Send each pair only its own page of the QR PDF; never post codes in a group. Fill the app user register: code → members → phone
Training day	Pairs practise on their live codes; check in Central that every pair sent a practice household, F4 and F10
Diwali break	No entries. Remind pairs the day before the break
Day before survey	AIIMS backs up and deletes all practice data; you confirm phones have empty Drafts and Sent
Day 1	The evening report shows any late practice form; AIIMS removes it

Lost phone or a code shared by mistake: tell AIIMS the same day; the code is revoked and re-issued.

Quality

Observation (F9), back-checks (F8), F4 sign-off

Your day

Morning	Call each pair: cluster, vehicle, phones charged, forms updated
In the field	Observe one pair (F9) or do back-checks (F8) in yesterday's clusters
Afternoon	Answer calls; decide only what the manual allows; escalate the rest
Evening	Check every pair sent its forms; review F4s; read the AIIMS daily report
Night	Plan tomorrow's observation and back-check households

Observation with F9

When

- Every pair on its first or second field day
- Then each pair at least every second field day (observation or back-checks)
- Again after any serious flag in the daily report
- Choose the activity: segmentation and selection, interviews, or record verification

How

- Watch without taking over; 17 Yes / No / NA checks
- Record GPS and the number of interviews observed
- Give feedback on the spot, privately
- Overall rating 3 (serious problem): stop the pair and call AIIMS; the work may have to be repeated

Back-checks with F8

Which households	Those the household form flagged at random (about 1 in 10 completed); the AIIMS daily report lists them
Plus	Any household flagged by the daily checks, or up to 3 per cluster you visit
When	Within 48 hours of the interview
How	Blind: never look at the original answers. Re-ask the counts and, per child, offered and swallowed; then ask how the visit was done
Who	The nodal officer or SR, never the pair that did the interview

AIIMS compares F8 with the original. Repeated differences in H5b or swallowed → retrain the pair, and re-do the cluster if needed.

Signing off F4

Segments	Made = planned; if not, the reason is written and you agreed
Large unit	Parts made and part drawn recorded; parts sketch photographed
Selection	List A or B recorded; households numbered is plausible for a segment
Results	Total selected households = expected (± 2) or explained
Children	Child forms completed = children listed
Sites	School UDISE+ and AWC recorded; F10 sent for both

Daily data checks: what the AIIMS report shows

Check	Flag when	What you do
Forms received vs schedule	Cluster with no forms by evening	Call the pair
“No one can answer” for a child	Above 5% of a pair’s children	Ask about revisits; observe the pair
Interview length	Under 3 minutes for a household with children	Back-check that household
GPS points	Households far apart or outside the cluster	Check the segment with the pair
F4 result total	Differs from household forms sent	Pair corrects or explains
F10 not verifiable, VF outside range	Any site	Read the reason; no action at the site

Independence and problems

What you protect, and what you escalate

Protecting independence

Welcome

- DIO and BMO: letters, vehicles, introductions
- ASHA, AWW: guide the team round the village, then leave
- Development partners (Evidence Action, Nutrition International): logistics and contacts

Not allowed

- Anyone who distributed tablets present during interviews or recounts
- Advance notice of clusters to villages
- Sharing household data or interim results in the district
- Correcting registers after the team’s visit

Problems: what you decide, what you escalate

Problem	You decide	Escalate to AIIMS
Unit much bigger or smaller than planned	Large-unit steps as in F4	Segments differ from plan
Village or ward not found	Check with BMO, panchayat, municipal office	Still not found: replacement
Household refuses or is locked	Result code; one revisit	Refusals above 10% in a cluster
Worker insists on sitting in	Politely ask them to wait outside	They refuse: stop and call
Phone lost or broken	Replacement phone	New QR code needed
Safety, hostility, accident	Withdraw the pair	Always report

Contacts

AIIMS Bhopal (central team)

- Survey coordinator: [name, phone]
- Data manager / ODK: [name, phone]
- Server: odk.cesndd.in

District NHM coordinators (DIO)

- Khandwa: Dr Anil Tantwar
- Chhindwara: Dr Pushpa Rani
- Ratlam: Dr Varsha Kureel
- Shahdol: [to be confirmed]